

SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE, OFFICES, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL FILING OR PRESENTENCE REPORT SEALED SYNTHETIC TWIN — FICTIONAL WORKBENCH PROJECTION ONLY; NOT A REAL PSR OR CM/ECF RECORD

Sealed Defendant Objection, Probation Position, and Government Response Packet

Completed: February 6, 2026 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-MDNC-25-CR-0328 **Sealed volume:** PSR-SV-2

This controlled packet combines the defendant's January 23 objection, the probation officer's January 30 position, and the government's February 6 response. It is paired with public docket surrogate DE31 but is independently worded and contains the exercise substance necessary for sentencing review.

All facts are fictional and deliberately abstract. The offense involved false reimbursement claims for services not performed against Meridian Community Supply Cooperative, with no transaction mechanics, credentials, routing data, account information, or reusable method supplied. Protected subject markers use inert labels. **Fact - Aster** identifies offense-conduct material; **Role - Beryl** identifies the disputed person-role analysis; **Range - Cinder** identifies the sentencing calculation.

The packet remains automatically sealed as presentence-related material. A synthetic workbench permission to view it is not authorization to access PACER, CM/ECF, Probation, or any genuine report. The only contested Guidelines issue is whether Mateo Serrano managed or supervised Alina Pared as a person. No party relies on management of property, assets, or activities alone.

Defendant's January 23 Objection

Mateo Serrano, through Celia Arden, objects to the proposed three-level adjustment under U.S.S.G. § 3B1.1(b). He accepts responsibility for knowing participation in the charged conspiracy and does not dispute that the offense involved exactly five criminally responsible participants. The objection is limited to his relationship with Alina Pared.

The defense contends that **Fact-Aster** shows cooperation among participants rather than direction by Serrano. According to the objection, Pared made her own decisions about whether and when to participate, no employment or command relationship existed, and the abstract record does not identify an instruction that she was obliged to follow. Serrano's familiarity with portions of the claimed reimbursements, the defense says, is not itself supervision of another person.

The objection recognizes that § 3B1.1(b) asks whether the defendant was a manager or supervisor and that the criminal activity involved five or more participants or was otherwise extensive. It argues that the numerical condition alone cannot replace the required person-management finding. The defense asks Probation to remove the adjustment from the final calculation or identify the particular interpersonal conduct said to satisfy **Role-Beryl**.

Categories of Protected Support

The defense relies on the stipulated factual basis, discovery summaries, and the absence of an agreed role provision in the plea agreement. These exercise materials describe false claims only at a high level. They do not contain authentic operational details, personal identifiers, financial accounts, or instructions for committing or concealing an offense.

The objection sorts its support into three inert categories. **Fact-Aster** concerns what the abstract offense record says Serrano and Pared each did. **Role-Beryl** concerns whether their relationship amounted to management or supervision. **Position-Echo** concerns the sentencing treatment the defense requests if the adjustment is not applied.

Serrano does not argue that he merely controlled assets and therefore qualifies for the adjustment under an asset-management theory. His point is the opposite: the Guidelines require proof that he managed or supervised another participant, and he maintains that the evidence does not establish that fact. He likewise does not contest the five-person count. The resulting dispute is narrow enough for the court to decide without reconstructing any transaction or exposing protected personal history. The objection preserves the issue for the sentencing hearing while leaving all other accepted plea facts undisturbed.

Specific Role-Enhancement Objection

The proposed Role-Beryl finding states that Serrano managed or supervised Alina Pared during the conspiracy. The defense objects because the cited exercise episodes show requests and shared planning, not authority over her conduct. Pared is one of the five responsible participants, but participant status does not establish that another participant supervised her.

The defense emphasizes that the plea left role unresolved. Serrano admitted knowing participation from August 4 through November 2, 2025, and stipulated to aggregate loss and restitution of \$186,400. He did not admit that Pared acted at his direction. The sealed summaries describe Pared as retaining discretion to decline, modify, or independently complete her part of the fictional activity.

Under the defense reading, § 3B1.1(b) requires proof by a preponderance that Serrano exercised managerial or supervisory responsibility over at least one other criminally responsible person. See *United States v. Steffen*, 741 F.3d 411, 414–16 (4th Cir. 2013). Familiarity, coordination, or a significant personal role does not necessarily answer that interpersonal question. Serrano therefore asks the court to find total offense level 17 rather than 20 and to calculate the advisory range without the disputed three levels.

Probation Position Dated January 30

Niko Faye reviewed the objection and retained the proposed adjustment in the probation position. The officer agrees that the only valid theory is management or supervision of a person and does not treat control over assets, property, or activities as sufficient by itself.

Probation reads **Fact - Aster** as showing that Serrano selected Pared for a defined portion of the conspiracy, communicated expectations about completion, and checked whether she carried them out. The position characterizes those fictional interactions as more than equal coordination. It does not assert that Serrano managed Corin Bell, Darius Venn, or Nessa Holt, and it does not increase the total participant count beyond five.

The officer's **Range - Cinder** calculation uses the 2025 Guidelines Manual because the offense continued through November 2, 2025. With the three-level adjustment, Probation calculates total offense level 20, criminal history category I, and an advisory imprisonment range of 33 to 41 months. Without the adjustment, the position identifies level 17 and a range of 24 to 30 months. Probation leaves the contested factual finding to Judge Elara Venn and treats the objection as unresolved for the final report and hearing.

Government Response Filed February 6

The fictional United States, through Bram Ives, asks the court to overrule the defense objection. The response accepts the same legal boundary described by the defense and Probation: the government must show that Serrano managed or supervised at least one criminally responsible person. It relies only on his alleged relationship with Alina Pared.

The government argues that the protected Fact - Aster summaries show a recurring pattern rather than a single request among equals. In its characterization, Serrano assigned Pared a defined responsibility, set expectations, monitored completion, and corrected a departure from the agreed task. The response avoids transaction mechanics and supplies no credential, account, routing, evasion, or concealment information.

The government does not contend that Serrano owned relevant property or managed abstract activities. It instead asks for a person-focused finding under Role - Beryl. It also acknowledges that exactly five participants were criminally responsible and that the plea agreement did not predetermine the adjustment. Because the role issue remained open, the government treats the objection procedure and sentencing hearing as the proper means to resolve it. The response requests retention of the three-level adjustment in the court's advisory calculation.

Government's Person-Management Analysis

The response identifies Alina Pared as the single alleged supervisee. It maintains that Serrano's communications, viewed together, conveyed what she was expected to accomplish and that his later follow-up reflected authority to demand completion. The government characterizes Pared's discretion over minor details as compatible with supervision rather than proof of equal status.

The defense disputes that inference. For purposes of this response, the government accepts that Pared could decline participation and was not Serrano's employee. It argues that formal employment, exclusive control, and constant oversight are not necessary if the court finds that Serrano exercised managerial responsibility over her participation in the fictional offense.

This *Role-Beryl* position is deliberately confined to interpersonal conduct. The government does not invoke the superseded idea that managing property, assets, or activities alone can support the enhancement. It cites the person-management requirement described in *Steffen*, 741 F.3d at 414–16, and asserts that the preponderance standard is met on the protected record. The response asks for a factual finding at sentencing, recognizes that factual role findings are ordinarily reviewed for clear error, and takes no position in this packet about any later appellate proceeding.

Unresolved Matters for Hearing

The parties agree on several boundaries that narrow the hearing. The charged conspiracy ended November 2, 2025; the 2025 Guidelines Manual applies; the criminal activity had exactly five responsible participants; and the only disputed role relationship is Serrano's alleged supervision of Pared. The plea did not resolve that matter.

They disagree about the inference drawn from **Fact - Aster**. The defense describes voluntary collaboration without authority. Probation and the government describe assignment, monitoring, and correction sufficient to support person management. Judge Venn must decide whether the government has proved the latter account by a preponderance.

The calculation consequences are also undisputed. A finding for the government yields total offense level 20 and an advisory range of 33 to 41 months for a defendant in criminal history category I. A finding for Serrano yields level 17 and a range of 24 to 30 months. Neither range fixes the sentence, and the court retains its obligation to consider the statutory sentencing factors. This matrix records the questions for hearing; it does not decide them or forecast a sentence.

Protected Service and Access

Celia Arden served the January 23 objection through the closed synthetic presentence channel. Niko Faye circulated the January 30 position to authorized defense and government counsel. Bram Ives served the February 6 response through the same exercise channel. Judge Venn and designated court staff received the packet for sentencing preparation.

No genuine email address, user account, password, filing credential, or court-system path is included. The sealed volume identifier PSR-SV-2 is fictional. Its public counterpart is a docket surrogate and category index, not a redacted presentence report. Opening the public entry does not confer permission to view this packet.

The automatic sealed treatment follows from the packet's direct relationship to presentence material. No discretionary motion or separate order created that status. Exercise access is disclosure-specific and temporary, and it represents only a workbench projection. The restriction protects *History-Dovetail*, *Person-Fable*, and other nonpublic categories even though this packet uses no raw personal identifiers. Authorized use is limited to analysis of the fictional sentencing record and does not imply access to any real probation or court repository.

Packet Certification

Niko Faye certifies that the packet contains the defense objection submitted January 23, the probation position completed January 30, and the government response filed February 6. Each component concerns the same proposed § 3B1.1(b) adjustment and the same alleged person-management relationship.

The packet accurately states the shared calculations: total offense level 20 and 33 to 41 months if the three-level adjustment applies; total offense level 17 and 24 to 30 months if it does not; criminal history category I in either event. It also accurately limits the participant count to Mateo Serrano, Alina Pared, Corin Bell, Darius Venn, and Nessa Holt.

The certification does not resolve the objection. It confirms that all scheduled views were delivered for Judge Venn's consideration before sentencing and that the final report may preserve the dispute for a ruling. Every person, office, identifier, and fact is synthetic. **Fact - Aster**, **Role - Beryl**, **Range - Cinder**, **History - Dovetail**, **Position - Echo**, and **Person - Fable** are inert exercise labels, not codes for real information. The sealed packet is paired with DE31 solely for controlled workbench navigation.